

The Media Story

What the product promises, and who it imagines, compared with your real user. Spend 15 minutes with real ads, the app store page or official notices first.

Step 1 · Who does the product think it's for? Describe the person the ads show. Then describe the person who really uses it. The **gap between the two** is what this tool is looking for.

THE PERSON IN THE ADS

Who: [a smiling student]

Has: [own laptop, bright desk]

Doing it: [in one sitting, relaxed]

YOUR REAL USER

Who: [Meera, 19, first-gen]

Has: [a phone at 12%, hostel Wi-Fi]

Doing it: [over 3 days, worried]

THE MISMATCH

The ads assume [a laptop, a scanner and an hour], but my user has [a phone, a café and three days]

A · What it claims

Its main promise, in its own words

["one place for all scholarships"]

A word the ads keep using that the product doesn't live up to

["seamless"]

If a user described it to a friend, they'd say...

["upload karo, reject ho jao, phir se karo"]

B · The story it sells

Where the ads' story starts

[log-in]

Where it ends

["Submitted"]

What it skips

[getting documents, the café, the waiting]

C · What the designers set out to do

The problem they set out to solve, in their own words (launch page, tender, About)

["let students apply for every scholarship on one platform"]

The user they imagined

[own laptop, scanner, broadband]

What they designed against, and what it costs users

[fraud; heavy document checks for everyone]

D · How users experience it

First time (signing up)

[asked for an ID she didn't have with her]

Using it (the main task)

[upload rejected twice, no reason given]

Afterwards (waiting, coming back)

[status says "pending" for weeks]

yellow notes · what you found teal notes · what you think

↳ ONE LINE TO CARRY TO SYNTHESIS

[write it now, so you don't have to reread later]